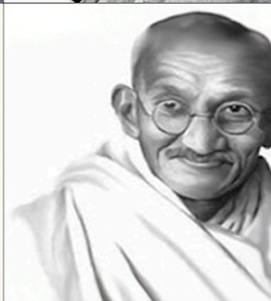


General Knowledge

Modern History

STUDY NOTES

**Socio - Religious Reform
Movements**



Socio-Religious Reform Movements

Introduction

- The socio-religious reform movements of the 19th and 20th centuries shaped modern Indian society.
- These movements emerged during a time when Indian culture was mired in deep-rooted social evils like **caste discrimination, untouchability, gender inequality, and rigid religious orthodoxy**.
- The British colonial rule, with its exploitative socio-economic policies and imposition of **Western culture**, further exacerbated the societal divisions.
- At the same time, the introduction of Western education and liberal ideas, coupled with global influences such as the French and American Revolutions, inspired enlightened Indians to initiate reforms.
- These movements aimed to eradicate inhuman practices such as **Sati, child marriage, female infanticide, and untouchability**, while promoting rational thinking, gender equality, and education for all.
- Reformers like **Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Jyotirao Phule, Sir Syed Ahmed Khan, and Swami Vivekananda** played a transformative role in addressing these issues, combining modernity with the essence of Indian traditions.
- They envisioned a society based on **equality, justice, and rationality** while resisting the cultural and religious imperialism of the British.
- The socio-religious reform movements are often termed the **"Indian Renaissance"**, as they revived the spirit of inquiry, rationality, and pride in India's cultural heritage.
- These movements brought about social and cultural awakening and laid the foundation for the Indian nationalist movement by fostering unity and a sense of collective identity among the people.
- These movements became instrumental in India's journey towards independence and modernity by addressing pressing social issues and resisting colonial exploitation.

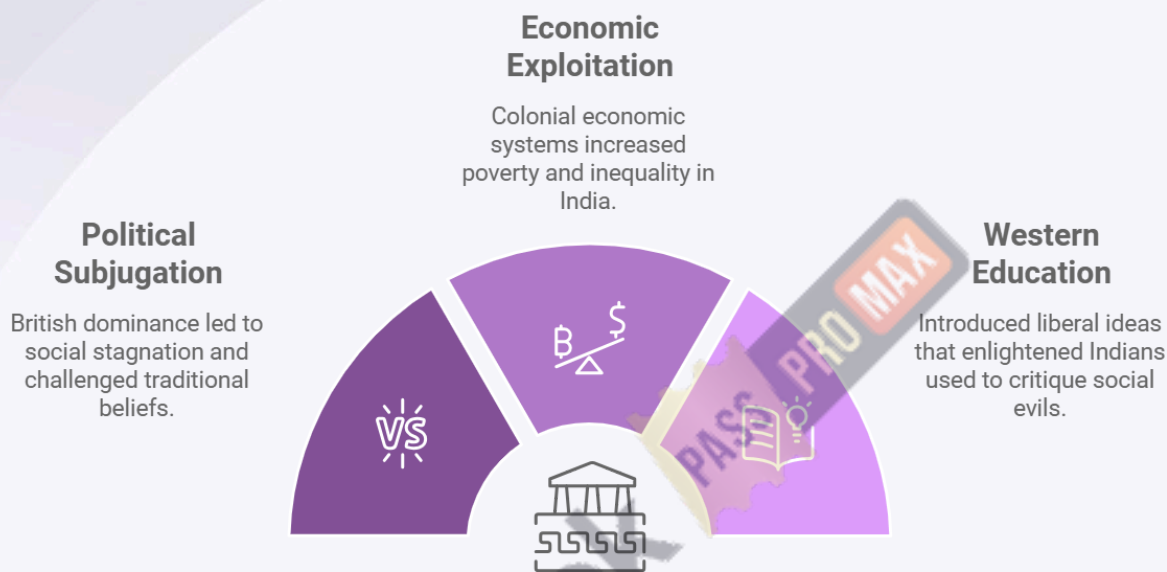
Reformer/Leader	Movement/Organization	Key Contributions
Raja Ram Mohan Roy	Brahmo Samaj (1828)	Abolition of Sati (1829), promoted widow remarriage, women's education, monotheism, and rationality.
Debendranath Tagore	Adi Brahmo Samaj (1842)	Rational outlook, systematic study of Indian traditions, promoted reformist ideas of Brahmo Samaj.
Keshab Chandra Sen	Brahmo Samaj of India (1866)	Opposed caste discrimination, supported universal religion, and promoted the inclusion of all faiths.
Henry Louis Vivian Derozio	Young Bengal Movement	He advocated rationalism, women's education, liberal values, and freedom of thought inspired by the French Revolution.
Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar	Widow Remarriage Association	Supported the Widow Remarriage Act (1856), promoted women's education, and opposed child marriage and polygamy.
Mahadev Govind Ranade	Prarthana Samaj (1867)	Worked for caste equality, widow remarriage, women's education, and emphasized Hindu-Muslim unity.
Jyotirao Phule	Satyashodhak Samaj (1873)	Advocated lower-caste rights, opposed Brahmin dominance, promoted women's education, and authored Gulamgiri.
Dayanand Saraswati	Arya Samaj (1875)	Promoted Vedic teachings, opposed idol worship, supported the Shuddhi movement, and emphasized gender equality.

Swami Vivekananda	Ramakrishna Mission (1897)	Highlighted Indian culture globally, promoted Vedantic principles and established education/social institutions.
Sir Syed Ahmed Khan	Aligarh Movement	Founded Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College, promoted modern education for Muslims, and advocated Hindu-Muslim unity.
Mirza Ghulam Ahmad	Ahmadiyya Movement (1889)	Advocated universal religion, opposed Jihad, and supported religious tolerance and liberalism.
Deoband Movement Leaders	Deoband School	Focused on pure Quranic teachings, opposed Western influences, and emphasized Islamic education.
Dadabhai Naoroji	Rahnumai Mazdayasnan Sabha (1851)	Promoted modern education, uplifted Parsi women, and exposed British exploitation through economic studies.
Behramji Malabari	Seva Sadan (1885)	Campaigned against child marriage and polygamy, and supported the Age of Consent Act (1891).
Savitribai Phule	Mahila Seva Mandal	The first female teacher in India promoted education for girls, widow remarriage, and fought against infanticide.
Pandita Ramabai	Arya Mahila Samaj	Advocated women's education, opposed child marriage, and founded institutions like Sharda Sadan.
Annie Besant	Women's India Association (1917)	Campaigned for women's suffrage and education, co-founded Banaras Hindu University, and led the

		Home Rule Movement.
Sarala Devi	Bharat Stree Mahamandal	Promoted women's education, and socio-economic rights, and worked against purdah.
Margaret Cousins	All India Women's Conference (1927)	Advocated for women's rights, social justice, and economic equality.
Sree Narayana Guru	SNDP Movement	Advocated "One caste, one religion, one God," temple entry for all, and anti-caste reforms.
C.V. Raman	Indian Science Research	Nobel Prize for Raman Effect, contributed to global recognition of Indian science.
Srinivasa Ramanujan	Indian Mathematics	Made revolutionary contributions to pure mathematics.
P.C. Mahalanobis	Indian Statistics	Established statistical sciences in India and founded the Indian Statistical Institute.
Singh Sabha Leaders	Singh Sabha Movement	Promoted Sikh education, preserved Sikh identity, and propagated the Gurmukhi script.
Shiromani Akali Dal Leaders	Akali Movement	Gurudwara reforms and community-based religious control in Sikh institutions.
Kandukuri Veeresalingam	Veda Samaj	Supported women's education, and widow remarriage, and published Telugu journals advocating social reforms.

Chembeti Sridharalu Naidu	Veda Samaj	Inspired by Brahmo Samaj, worked for caste equality, widow remarriage, and the abolition of superstitions.
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Factors Leading to Socio-Religious Reform Movements



Raja Ram Mohan Roy and Brahmo Samaj (1828)

Raja Ram Mohan Roy's Reforms

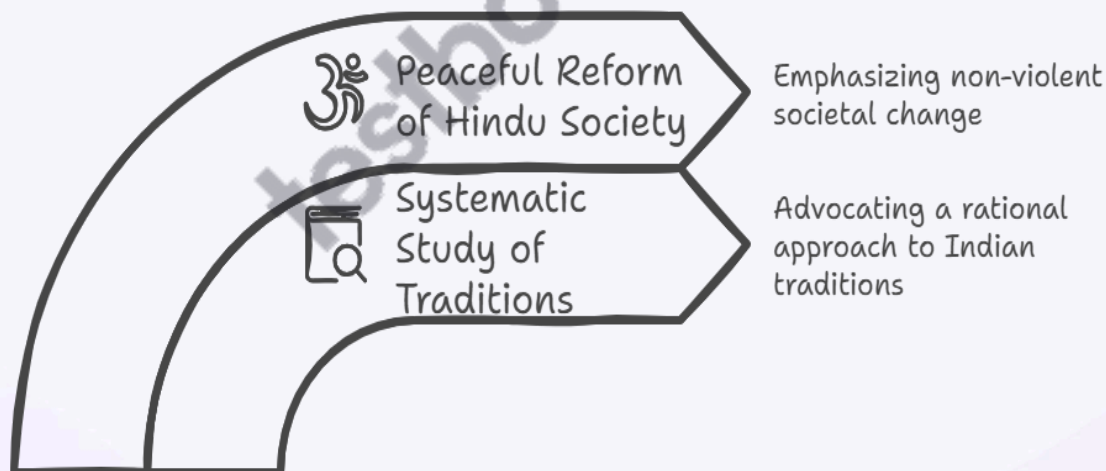


- He founded the Brahmo Samaj to promote monotheism, reject idol worship, and eliminate superstitions.
- He advocated for the abolition of Sati, leading to the passage of the Sati Regulation Act (1829).
- Supported women's education and property inheritance rights.
- Rejected polytheism and caste discrimination while emphasizing rational thinking.

Debendranath Tagore and Adi Brahmo Samaj (1842)

- Expanded the reformist ideology of the Brahmo Samaj by founding the Adi Brahmo Samaj.
- Advocated systematic study of Indian traditions with rationality.
- Emphasized the peaceful reform of Hindu society.

Adi Brahmo Samaj's Reformist Ideology



Keshab Chandra Sen and Brahmo Samaj of India (1866)

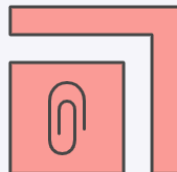
- Split from Adi Brahmo Samaj to create the Brahmo Samaj of India.
- Focused on radical social reforms like caste abolition and interfaith inclusivity.

- Promoted women's education and marriage reforms.

Brahmo Samaj of India

Marriage Reforms

Promoting progressive changes in marriage practices to ensure fairness.



Caste Abolition

The movement's commitment to ending caste discrimination and promoting equality.

Women's Education

Advocating for educational opportunities and empowerment for women.



Interfaith Inclusivity

Emphasizing harmony and cooperation among different religious communities.

Henry Louis Vivian Derozio and the Young Bengal Movement

- Leader of the Young Bengal Movement centered on rationalism and liberal thought.
- Encouraged debates on religion and superstitions.
- Advocated for women's education and freedom of expression.
- Inspired by Enlightenment ideals and the French Revolution.

Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar and Widow Remarriage Association

- Advocated widow remarriage and legal reforms through the Widow Remarriage Act (1856).
- Promoted girls' education and opposed child marriage.
- Played a vital role in modernizing the Bengali language.

Mahadev Govind Ranade and Prarthana Samaj (1867)

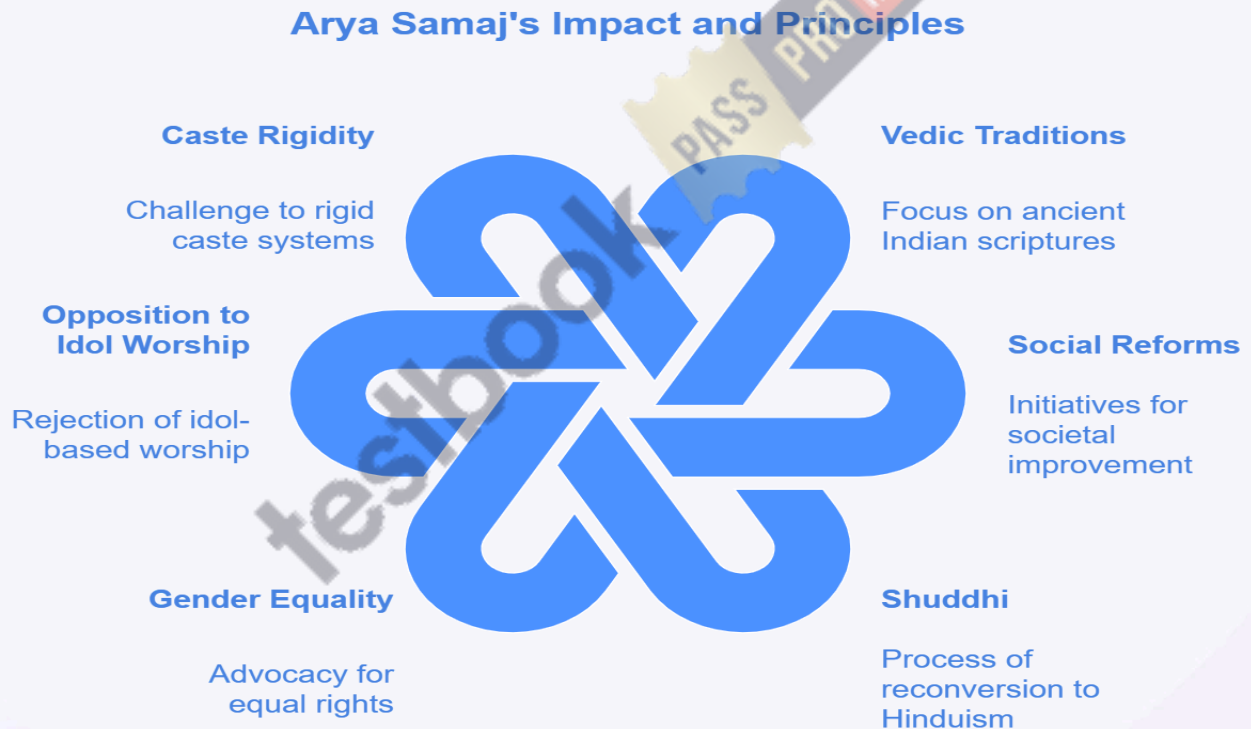
- Co-founded the Prarthana Samaj, a social reform organization inspired by Brahmo Samaj.

- Fought for caste equality, widow remarriage, and Hindu-Muslim unity.
- Integrated social reforms with emerging nationalist movements.

Jyotirao Phule and Satyashodhak Samaj (1873)

- Founded the Satyashodhak Samaj to uplift oppressed castes and women.
- Opposed Brahminical dominance in rituals and education.
- Opened schools for lower castes and girls.
- Also wrote Gulamgiri, exposing caste oppression.

Dayanand Saraswati and Arya Samaj (1875)



- Established the Arya Samaj to revive Vedic traditions and promote social reforms.
- Advocated for Shuddhi (reconversion) and gender equality.
- Opposed idol worship, caste rigidity, and rituals.

Swami Vivekananda and Ramakrishna Mission (1897)

- Founded the Ramakrishna Mission for social service and spiritual upliftment.

Journey of Ramakrishna Mission

Educational Institutions

Establishing institutions for education and social welfare.

Global Cultural Highlight

Showcasing Indian culture at the World Parliament of Religions in 1893.

Founding Mission

Establishing the Ramakrishna Mission for social service and spiritual upliftment.



- Highlighted Indian culture globally, especially at the World Parliament of Religions (1893).
- Established institutions for education and social welfare.

Sir Syed Ahmed Khan and the Aligarh Movement

- Initiated the Aligarh Movement to modernize Muslim education.
- Founded the Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College (later Aligarh Muslim University).
- Emphasized rationalism and Hindu-Muslim unity.

Mirza Ghulam Ahmad and Ahmadiyya Movement (1889)

- Founded the Ahmadiyya Movement, focusing on universal brotherhood.
- Opposed Jihad and emphasized peaceful propagation of Islam.
- Advocated religious tolerance and liberalism.

Deoband Movement Leaders

- Founded the Deoband School to preserve Islamic teachings and identity.

- Opposed British influences and Western culture.
- Focused on Quranic teachings and religious education.

Dadabhai Naoroji and Rahnumai Mazdayasnan Sabha (1851)

- Co-founded the Rahnumai Mazdayasnan Sabha to reform Parsi practices.
- Promoted education for Parsi women and social modernization.
- Critiqued British exploitation in Poverty and Un-British Rule in India.

Behramji Malabari and Seva Sadan (1885)

- Established Seva Sadan for women's welfare.
- Fought against child marriage and polygamy.
- Advocated for the Age of Consent Act (1891).

Singh Sabha Movement and Akali Movement

- Promoted Sikh identity through the Singh Sabha Movement and Akali Movement.
- Focused on Gurudwara reforms and preservation of Gurmukhi script.
- Strengthened community control over Sikh religious institutions.

Savitribai Phule and Mahila Seva Mandal

- Promoted women's rights and education through the Mahila Seva Mandal.
- Opened schools for girls and fought against female infanticide.
- Advocated for widow remarriage.

Pandita Ramabai and Arya Mahila Samaj

- Founded the Arya Mahila Samaj to promote women's education and rights.
- Opposed child marriage and created opportunities for women in higher education.

Annie Besant and Women's India Association (1917)

- Established the Women's India Association to campaign for women's suffrage.
- Played a vital role in the Home Rule Movement and co-founded Banaras Hindu University.

Margaret Cousins and All India Women's Conference (1927)

- Co-founded the All India Women's Conference.
- Advocated for equal social and economic opportunities for women.

Sree Narayana Guru and SNDP Movement

- Led the SNDP Movement to promote social equality.
- Advocated "One caste, one religion, one God."
- Fought for temple entry rights and caste reforms.

C.V. Raman and Indian Science

- Contributed to India's scientific renaissance.
- Won the Nobel Prize for Physics for discovering the Raman Effect.

Srinivasa Ramanujan and Indian Mathematics

- Revolutionized modern mathematics.
- Made groundbreaking contributions to number theory and mathematical analysis.

P.C. Mahalanobis and Indian Statistics

- Founded the Indian Statistical Institute.
- Pioneered statistical studies and applied them to planning and economic policy.

Kandukuri Veeresalingam and Veda Samaj

- Advocated for women's rights through the Veda Samaj.
- Promoted widow remarriage and girls' education in Andhra Pradesh.

Chembeti Sridharalu Naidu and Veda Samaj

- Worked for social reform through the Veda Samaj.
- Focused on caste equality and the abolition of superstitions.

Shiromani Akali Dal and Gurudwara Reforms

- Led the Akali Movement for Gurudwara reforms.
- Ensured community-based control over Sikh religious institutions.